

City Council Meeting September 8th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eXv-sdz9j7g
Publication Date	2025-09-10T02:28:19Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie City Common Council

Meeting Date: September 8, 2025

Report Type: Comprehensive Community Summary

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Statutory Public Hearings ([00:00:30](#) & [00:05:54](#) & [00:08:18](#)) on Proposed 2026 Budgets.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Held prior to the regular meeting, the Council opened public hearings for **Ordinance 30-25** (Civil Budget Appropriations and Tax Rates), **Ordinance 31-25** (Muncie Indiana Transit System Budget), and **Ordinance 32-25** (Muncie Sanitary District Budget). Public testimony was received regarding tax burdens, income tax offsets, transit schedules, and administrative budget submissions. The hearing was recessed and adjourned to reconvene at the main meeting due to a time publication discrepancy between local newspaper notices (noted as 6:45 PM) and the Gateway portal (noted as 7:00 PM).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular session of the Muncie City Common Council to order at approximately [01:33:33](#).
 - **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dishman, Selby, Macintosh, Green, Powell, Garrett, Golian, Basham, and Mason. (All 9 members present).
 - **Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Council President Mason.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Opening Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer.
 - Invocation delivered by Councilman Green ([01:16:39](#)).
 - Citizens Recognition: Councilman William McIntosh presented the September 2025 Citizenship Award to Tara Gudger, a middle school counselor, athletic director, and community advocate ([01:17:34](#)).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the August meeting were approved by voice vote ([02:23:15](#)).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Zoning & Traffic Ordinances

- [00:25:44](#) **Ordinance 26-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from R-4 Resident Zone to BC Community Business Zone at 1600 North Wheeling Avenue.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeks to allow a change in use from residential to retail. Received a 7-0 favorable recommendation from the Plan Commission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced and approved by voice vote.
- [00:27:42](#) **Ordinance 27-25:** An Ordinance to Amend the City of Muncie Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance from R-5 Resident Zone to CB Central Business Zone at 718 North Walnut Street.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilman Dishman.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Matches zoning of adjacent properties and allows replatting after town home construction. Developer Jonathan Chandlas (Crew Properties) spoke on the 7-unit market-rate townhome project.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Jonathan Chandlas (Developer) and local residents discussed project details and zero-tolerance expectations for crime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote; motion to suspend rules failed roll-call vote (due to lack of unanimity, with Councilman Powell voting “no”), leaving the ordinance for regular adoption next month (03:30:30).
- **00:37:17 Ordinance 28-25:** An Ordinance Amending Traffic Schedules (Chapter 80) <U+2013> Speed Limit Reduction.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilman Powell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reduces speed limits from 30 to 25 MPH on McKenzie Street, Tyrone Drive, Shellbark Road, and Bittersweet Lane between West View Boulevard and Riverside Avenue. City engineer consented.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Sarah Williams (20-year resident) spoke in strong support, highlighting safety concerns, lack of sidewalks, and school children presence.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced, rules suspended, and adopted unanimously by roll-call vote (00:42:41 and 00:43:14).
- **00:43:38 Ordinance 29-25:** An Ordinance Amending Traffic Schedules (Chapter 80) <U+2013> University Avenue Parking.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilman Basham.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Prohibits parking at any time on both sides of University Avenue between Dick Street and Reserve Street, and the south side between Wheeling Avenue and Reserve Street. Mayor Ridenour presented research data and letters of support from Ball State University, downtown development, and the Arts Commission regarding bike lane/trail connections. Riverside Normal City Neighborhood Association strongly opposed due to alley degradation and parking loss.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Beth Mesner (Treasurer, Riverside Normal City NA) vehemently opposed, citing alley congestion and lack of consultation.
 - Jim Lee (Resident) spoke in favor, citing traffic flow and emergency access.
 - Sarah Vitali (Resident) criticized data rigor.
 - Chris Paladino (Ball State University) spoke on behalf of the university’s partnership and Lily Endowment grant.
 - Todd Me (Resident) questioned Ball State’s community contributions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced for discussion; hand vote conducted to move forward for further review and committee refinement (01:20:01).

Budget Ordinances

- **01:22:20 Ordinance 30-25:** Ordinance for Appropriations and Tax Rates <U+2013> 2026 Muncie Civil Budget.

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Finance Committee.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Council discussed the ongoing budget review process, state constraints (Senate Bill 1), hiring freezes, and fund allocations. Amendments were introduced to incorporate late-submitted budget forms (Forms 1, 2, 3, and 4B).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Christopher Bilbury noted unaddressed staffing positions.
 - Cameron Grubs inquired about the budget timeline and process.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended and introduced by roll-call vote (01:34:36).
- **01:35:00 Ordinance 31-25:** Ordinance for Appropriations and Tax Rates <U+2013> 2026 Muncie Indiana Transit System (MITS) Budget.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amanda Price (General Manager, MITS).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amanda Price answered questions regarding bus driver shortages and ridership increases.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Questions raised regarding Sunday service feasibility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended (adding Forms 1, 2, 3, 4B) and introduced by roll-call vote (01:35:59).
- **01:39:23 Ordinance 32-25:** Ordinance for Appropriations and Tax Rates <U+2013> 2026 Muncie Sanitary District Budget.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dina Cox (Financial Manager, MSD).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Brief presentation by financial management; no major opposition.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced and approved by voice vote (01:40:30).

Resolutions

- **01:40:55 Resolution 16-25:** Resolution Relating to the Financing of a Fire Station Project (Station 5 replacement on Tillotson Avenue) and Approving Taxpayer Petition Forms.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Councilman requested to pull/table the item to prioritize budget work.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Withdrawn/Tabled by the sponsor without objection (01:41:51).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:42:44 Alan Cornblau & Katherine Mitchell (Muncie Public Library):** Provided an informational update on the library's upcoming budget (anticipating a slight decrease due to circuit breakers), branch updates (Kennedy Library winning "Quest for the Best"), 150th Carnegie anniversary celebration on November 6, and ongoing legal work regarding the Westminster annexation card issue.

- **01:53:10 Charles Jameson:** Inquired about status updates on the old Chevy plant property cleanup (fencing repairs underway via mayoral communication) and Common Market zoning discussions.
 - **01:56:24 Troy Walters:** Announced Boy Scout Troop 22's annual burgoo fundraiser at the fairgrounds (Saturday, 11 AM to 6 PM) and highlighted community service projects.
 - **02:00:32 "Billy" (Resident):** Raised concerns regarding ongoing issues with council member emails and communications.
 - **02:02:43 Lyn Thornberg:** Spoke on behalf of her property sale at 1304 North Tillotson Avenue, complaining that prolonged city construction staging and barrels in front of her home are hindering home sales. Councilman Mason agreed to contact project leads (Rob Keyling) to improve site management.
 - **02:08:28 Cameron Grubs:** Celebrated the local Pride event success, announced the upcoming Washington Street Festival and Muncie Bridge Dinner, and asked follow-up questions regarding executive department head salaries exceeding budget caps.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Finance Committee meetings scheduled for the upcoming days and September 23 to review department budgets.
 - Budget adoption scheduled for the next regular meeting on October 6.
 - **Adjournment:** Meeting officially adjourned by unanimous voice vote at the conclusion of public comments (**02:11:58**).
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